

Wednesday, 26 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Showers 27° 19°	BIRMINGHAM Showers 23° 16°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 22° 17°	GLASGOW Rain 22° 14°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The Met Office has issued yellow weather warnings for much of the UK, with thunderstorms and heavy rain expected to sweep across the country.

Forecasters say these conditions could lead to localised flooding and disruption as the unsettled weather moves northwards throughout Wednesday. It's a good idea to check local forecasts before you travel.

WEATHER · UK
- 2

More than 70,000 social and affordable homes are set to be built across England over the next decade, thanks to new government funding.

Significant investment has been allocated to areas including Greater Manchester, the West Midlands, West Yorkshire, and London. This initiative aims to address the ongoing housing shortage.

HOUSING · UK
- 3

Greater Manchester Mayor Andy Burnham has not ruled out potential tax rises in the upcoming autumn Budget.

Experts are suggesting that both Mr Burnham and Chancellor John Healey will face tough decisions, with limited financial flexibility in their first Budget. It's a clear indication of the economic challenges ahead.

POLITICS · UK
- 4

Dozens of British holidaymakers are stranded in Tunisia after their flight to Belfast was cancelled, with some facing waits of up to 10 days.

One passenger reported spending over £4,000 to try and get his family of five home, highlighting the significant disruption and cost. Many are just desperate to get back to the UK.

TRAVEL · UK
- 5

The Lockerbie bombing trial has been postponed for a third time, just days before it was due to begin.

The delay comes after new evidence emerged in the 37-year-old case, which involves a Libyan man. It means further waiting for families seeking justice.

JUSTICE · UK

What's coming up

1 **Kit Harington is reportedly stepping into the magical world of HBO's Harry Potter series, replacing Nicholas Hoult as Gilderoy Lockhart.**

Hoult, who was announced for the role just two weeks ago, has apparently dropped out due to scheduling conflicts. It's a big change for the highly anticipated series.

ON AIR – What do you think of Kit Harington as Gilderoy Lockhart? Is he a good fit for the flamboyant character?

TV · COMING UP

2 **Get ready for a blast from the past, as Kate Hudson is set to make a sequel to the beloved rom-com 'How to Lose a Guy in 10 Days'.**

It's been 23 years since the original hit cinemas, and there's speculation that Matthew McConaughey could reunite with Hudson for the follow-up. Fans will be thrilled to see them back together.

ON AIR – Are you excited for a sequel to 'How to Lose a Guy in 10 Days'? What other rom-coms would you love to see return?

FILM · COMING UP

3 **The highly anticipated return of Prince Harry and Meghan to the UK is imminent, with details of their future life here gradually emerging.**

Speculation is rife about what their focus will be, with possibilities including charity work, acting projects, or even a quiet life in the Cotswolds. It's certainly going to be interesting to watch.

ON AIR – What do you think Harry and Meghan's main focus will be when they return to the UK? What would you like to see them do?

ROYALS · COMING UP

4 **Manga fans, get ready! A new theme park inspired by the popular Japanese art form is set to be built near Paris.**

The project is part of a massive €6bn investment from Saudi Arabia, which has given the green light to the construction of three new parks. It promises to be a fantastic attraction for fans.

ON AIR – Would you visit a manga-inspired theme park? What's your favourite theme park experience?

ATTRACTIONS · COMING UP

5 **The sons of 'The Wicker Man' director have completed their late father's folk horror film trilogy, more than 50 years after the original.**

This final film brings a sense of closure to the saga, and to the director's family, who have worked to realise his vision. It's a touching tribute to his legacy.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of folk horror? What's the best film trilogy you've ever watched?

FILM · COMING UP

On the schedule

- 1** **England cricket captain Joe Root has expressed his frustration and disappointment over an incident involving fast bowler Brydon Carse at a Derby nightclub.**

Root stated he was 'hacked off' by the situation, which has cast a shadow over the team. It's another off-field distraction for English cricket.

ON AIR – How much impact do off-field incidents like this have on a team's performance and morale?

CRICKET · UK
- 2** **Tottenham have made a significant signing, bringing in Brazilian winger Savinho from Manchester City for an initial £75 million.**

Interestingly, the player will revert to being called Savio at his new club. Spurs fans will be eager to see their new talent in action.

ON AIR – What impact do you think Savio will have at Tottenham? Is £75 million a fair price?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 3** **Sir Nick Faldo has suggested that LIV golfers looking to return to the DP World Tour might need to 'eat a bit of humble pie'.**

Faldo believes this could be a condition for regaining eligibility for the European-based circuit. It highlights the ongoing tension in professional golf.

ON AIR – Do you agree with Sir Nick Faldo that LIV golfers should 'eat humble pie' if they want to return?

GOLF · UK
- 4** **Former Wimbledon champion Marketa Vondrousova is appealing her four-year ban from tennis to the Court of Arbitration for Sport.**

Vondrousova was banned after not allowing an anti-doping official into her home for a test in December 2025. Her ban is currently set to run until June 2030.

ON AIR – What are your thoughts on athletes appealing anti-doping bans? How important is it to maintain strict testing protocols?

TENNIS · UK
- 5** **British fighter Ellie Scotney is confirmed to challenge WBC featherweight champion Tiara Brown in Arlington, Texas, on November 8th.**

This is a huge opportunity for Scotney to claim a world title. Boxing fans will be looking forward to this exciting matchup.

ON AIR – Do you think Ellie Scotney has what it takes to become a world champion? Who is your favourite British boxer right now?

BOXING · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A recent study suggests that spending time looking up at the night sky can significantly boost your sense of well-being.**
Researchers found that taking just a few minutes to observe stars or the moon can reduce daily stresses and foster a greater appreciation for nature's grandeur. Perhaps a lovely stargazing evening is in order this week!
- 2 The delightful trend of 'library of things' is growing across the UK, allowing communities to borrow useful household items instead of buying them.**
From drills to carpet cleaners and even gardening tools, these local initiatives help reduce waste and make expensive items accessible to everyone. It's a wonderful way to share and save.
- 3 New research indicates that people who regularly sing, even just in the shower, report feeling happier and more energised.**
It seems the act of singing releases endorphins and reduces stress hormones, regardless of vocal talent! So, don't be shy, let your voice be heard.
- 4 A fascinating study reveals that the simple act of 'doodling' during a meeting might actually be a good thing for memory and concentration.**
Far from being a sign of inattention, researchers found that doodling can help keep the mind from wandering too much, improving recall of spoken information. Who knew a few squiggles could be so productive?
- 5 The joy of 'upcycling old furniture' is experiencing a wonderful resurgence, with more people transforming pre-loved pieces into unique household treasures.**
It's a creative and sustainable way to refresh your home, giving new life to items that might otherwise be discarded. Plus, it's incredibly satisfying to see the before and after!
- 6 Scientists are exploring the fascinating world of 'animal friendships' between different species, with surprising results.**
From dogs befriending ducks to goats playing with horses, these heartwarming cross-species bonds remind us that companionship can be found in the most unexpected places. Nature truly is amazing.
- 7 A charming trend for 'community noticeboards' is blossoming in villages and towns, bringing local news and events back to the forefront.**
These physical boards, often beautifully decorated, serve as hubs for sharing everything from lost pets to local fêtes, fostering a lovely sense of local connection and community spirit.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new pair of shoes will be comfortable for a whole day, without actually walking around much?

ANSWER: WIGGLING OUR TOES INSIDE THEM REPEATEDLY, PERHAPS WITH A SUBTLE LITTLE BOUNCE!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, fresh piece of fruit, especially if it's a new variety.

ANSWER: GIVING IT A GOOD, PROPER SNIFF, SOMETIMES EVEN WITH CLOSED EYES, TO TRULY APPRECIATE ITS AROMA!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a certain 'smell' can instantly transport you back to a specific memory or a moment from your past?**

Whether it's the scent of freshly cut grass, baking bread, or even a particular perfume, what's a smell that instantly takes you down memory lane, and what memory does it evoke for you?

- **We all have those 'little everyday moments of satisfaction' that just make us feel quietly pleased, don't we?**

It could be something simple like finding a matching sock straight away, or getting all the washing pegged out just as the sun comes out. What's a recent small satisfaction that put a smile on your face?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is actually called a 'parliament'.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies taste with their antennae, allowing them to sense nectar from a distance.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's largest officially measured snowflake was 15 inches wide and 8 inches thick, observed in Montana, USA, in 1887.
- A flamingo's pink or reddish colour comes from pigments in the organisms they eat, such as brine shrimp and algae.
- The inventor of the Richter scale, Charles Richter, was apparently colourblind.
- The longest recorded flight of a chicken is 13 seconds.
- The 'Hobbit' movies used over 180 pairs of prosthetic Hobbit feet.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the only living structure on Earth visible from space.
- Bubble wrap was originally intended to be used as three-dimensional wallpaper.
- Australia is wider than the moon.

On this day

Day 238 of the year, 127 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alexander of Bergamo (Roman Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Blessed Ceferino Namuncurá; Christian feast day: Jeanne-Elisabeth Bichier des Ages; Christian feast day: Blessed John Paul I. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1993 — Keke Palmer, American actress and singer
- 1974 — Meredith Eaton, American actress
- 1940 — Nik Turner, English musician and songwriter (died 2022)
- 1969 — Adrian Young, American drummer and songwriter
- 1988 — Danielle Savre, American actress
- 1988 — Evan Ross, American actor
- 1946 — Alison Steadman, English actress
- 2002 — Lil Tecca, American rapper

THE DAY TODAY

- 2023 — Exactly 5 years after the 2018 Jacksonville Landing shooting, there is another shooting in Jacksonville, Florida, leaving 3 people dead.
- 1977 — The Charter of the French Language is adopted by the National Assembly of Quebec.
- 2018 — Three people are killed and eleven wounded during a mass shooting at a Madden NFL '19 video game tournament in Jacksonville, Florida.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1969 — Aeroflot Flight 1770 crashes while landing at Vnukovo International Airport, killing 16.
- 1997 — Beni Ali massacre occurs in Algeria, leaving 60 to 100 people dead.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1942 — The Holocaust in Ukraine: At Chortkiv, the Ukrainian police and German Schutzpolizei deport two thousand Jews to Bełżec extermination camp. Five hundred of the sick and children are murdered on the spot. This continued until the next day.
- 1970 — The fiftieth anniversary of American women being able to vote is marked by a nationwide Women's Strike for Equality.

- 1998 — The first flight of the Boeing Delta III ends in disaster 75 seconds after liftoff, resulting in the loss of the Galaxy X communications satellite.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 239 of the year, 126 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Baculus of Sorrento; Christian feast day: Caesarius of Arles; Christian feast day: David Lewis; Christian feast day: Decuman. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1943 — Chuck Girard, American singer-songwriter and pianist
- 1949 — Jeff Cook, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2022)
- 1998 — Rod Wave, American rapper, singer, and songwriter
- 1961 — Yolanda Adams, American singer, producer, and actress
- 1988 — Alexa PenaVega, American actress and singer
- 1984 — David Bentley, English footballer
- 1940 — Fernest Arceneaux, American singer and accordion player (died 2008)
- 1969 — Reece Shearsmith, English actor, comedian and writer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1962 — The Mariner 2 unmanned space mission is launched to Venus by NASA.
- 1991 — Moldova declares independence from the USSR.
- 1942 — First day of the Sarny Massacre, perpetrated by Germans and Ukrainians.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1956 — The nuclear power station at Calder Hall in the United Kingdom was connected to the national power grid becoming the world's first commercial nuclear power station to generate electricity on an industrial scale.
- 1982 — Turkish military diplomat Colonel Atilla Altıkat is shot and killed in Ottawa. Justice Commandos of the Armenian Genocide claim to be avenging the massacre of 1+½ million Armenians in the 1915 Armenian genocide.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar